

DEBANJAN DAS

Institute of Rural Management Anand (IRMA), Gujarat, India
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CURRENT POSITION

PhD Candidate, Public Policy, Institute of Rural Management Anand (IRMA), Gujarat, India
(Expected May 2027)

Thesis Title: Essays on Enterprise Development: Evidence from Financial and Managerial Interventions

Thesis Advisory Committee: Prof. Vivek Pandey (IIM Ahmedabad), Prof. Shyam Singh (IRMA), Prof. Indranil De (IRMA)

Teaching Assistantships:

- Applied Data Science (Prof. Vivek Pandey), IIMA, 2026
- Impact Evaluation (Prof. Vivek Pandey), IRMA, 2025
- Field Experiments for Social Policy (Prof. Vivek Pandey), IRMA, 2025
- Microeconomics (Prof. Vivek Pandey), IRMA, 2024
- Social Network Analysis (Prof. Shyam Singh), IRMA, 2024

Research Assistantships:

- Tamil Nadu Rural Transformation Project (TNRTP 2.0)
(Prof. Vivek Pandey, IIM Ahmedabad), IRMA *Mar 2025 – Present*
Supporting impact evaluation and M&E design for the World Bank-funded TNRTP 2.0 programme, including survey design and data analysis.
- Integrated Farming Cluster (IFC) Project
(Prof. Shyam Singh), IRMA *Aug 2024 – Mar 2025*
Supported implementation of the 214-cluster IFC Project, a collaborative initiative between RCRC and the Ministry of Rural Development. Conducted field surveys and data analysis for integrated farming systems across six major Indian states: West Bengal, Assam, Odisha, Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, and Madhya Pradesh.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. in Agricultural Extension**, ICAR-National Dairy Research Institute (NDRI), Karnal *2019–2021* [GPA: 8.40/10]
- **B.Sc. (Agriculture)**, Uttar Banga Krishi Vishwavidyalaya, West Bengal *2015–2019* [GPA: 7.91/10]

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Rural Entrepreneurship and Development
- Food and Nutrition
- Survey Methodology and Data Quality
- Behavioral Economics
- Causal Inference and Causal Machine Learning
- Agricultural Economics

RESEARCH

Working Papers

- Autonomy-Supportive Interviewer Feedback and Data Quality: Evidence from a Randomized Field Experiment in India (with Vivek Pandey, Elangbam Kyamba)

Status: Submitted

- Credit Constraints, Conditional Loan Subsidies, and Enterprise Performance: Evidence from a Developing Country (with Vivek Pandey, Akankshita Dey)

Work in Progress

- Post-Pandemic Resilience and Growth: Evaluating the Impact of the Nano Enterprise Financing Fund (NEFF) on Rural Enterprises in Tamil Nadu (with Vivek Pandey)
- Does Honesty Pay? Evidence from a Field Experiment on Dishonesty and Enterprise Performance in Informal Markets (with Vivek Pandey)

PRIMARY DATA COLLECTION

- Designed and implemented enterprise-level surveys for 8,000 enterprises across Tamil Nadu (2022–2024), in collaboration with Tamil Nadu Government and World Bank.
- Conducted 6,000 household surveys under the Integrated Farming Cluster (IFC) Project.
- Designed a three-arm interviewer training experiment in 120 villages in the state of Gujarat, India.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS & ACADEMIC WORKSHOPS

2026

- **7th Annual Economics Conference**, AMSOM, Ahmedabad University, January 9–10, 2026
“Credit Constraints, Conditional Loan Subsidies, and Enterprise Performance: Evidence from a Developing Country”

2025

- **Doctoral Colloquium in Management (DOCMAD)**, Institute of Rural Management Anand (IRMA), TSU, December 22–24, 2025
“Credit Constraints, Conditional Loan Subsidies, and Enterprise Performance: Evidence from a Developing Country”
Award: Third Best Prize, Advanced Research Paper Track
- **20th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development**, Indian Statistical Institute (ISI), New Delhi, December 18–20, 2025
“Autonomy-Supportive Interviewer Feedback and Data Quality: Evidence from a Randomized Field Experiment in India”

SKILLS

Languages Bengali (Native), Hindi (Fluent), English (Fluent)

Software Stata, R, Python, L^AT_EX, SurveyCTO, QGIS, Claude Code

REFERENCES

1. **Prof. Vivek Pandey**
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2. **Prof. Shyam Singh**
Professor, Social Science Area
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